Action Item

Recommendation to Approve a New Mascot for Columbia River High School

Rationale:
Pursuant of VPS Board Resolution 866, and in alignment with VPS Procedure 6970, The Columbia River High School Transition Team presents four potential mascot names.

Criterion were established for the team with the following characteristics in mind: "River's mascot should":

- Reflect the geographical or historical features of Hazel Dell, Vancouver, Washington state or the Pacific Northwest
- Avoid names that would cause confusion with other local school mascots, logos or images
- Celebrate the rich traditions, and history of Columbia River High School among the students alumni and community members

In accordance with Procedure 6970, River's Transition Team is composed of 25 members representing current students, alumni, and faculty and community members. This team was created with various stakeholders in mind. The team met on eight different afternoons between October and December in this effort to identify a new mascot. After soliciting, input the team reviewed over 700 suggestions from current students and the larger community.

The potential mascots presented are:

"Rapids" Rationale: Rapids are sections of a river where the river bed has a steep gradient and causes increase in water velocity and turbulence.

"River" Rationale: The "CR" logo has been in place for several decades. Respect, Integrity, Values, Excellence and Responsibility are a mantra associated with River.

'Royals" Rationale: Refers an imperial family reigning as a dynasty

"Sasquatch" Rationale: North American folklore (sometimes called "Big Foot") is a cryptid "wild man" creature

Fund Source:

Reviewed by the committee of the whole:

RESOLUTION NO. 866

A RESOLUTION of the Board of Directors of
Vancouver School District No. 37, Clark County, Washington
Recommending the Immediate Retirement of the Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos and nicknames at Columbia River High School and Minnehaha Elementary School.

A RESOLUTION of the Board of Directors of Vancouver School District No. 37 (hereinafter referred to as "district"), Clark County, Vancouver, Washington on immediate elimination of the Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames at Columbia River High School and Minnehaha Elementary School.

WHEREAS in 1993, the Washington State Board of Education adopted a resolution asking school districts to re-examine their policies regarding the use of Native American mascots; and

WHEREAS in 2005 the American Psychological Association, citing research documenting harm to Native American children, called for the immediate retirement of all Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames; and

WHEREAS many national organizations and tribes have called for the immediate retirement of the use of Native American mascots, including the National Congress of American Indians, the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People, the National Education Alliance, and the Affiliated Tribes of Northwest Indians; and

WHEREAS national student achievement data reveals that the achievement gap for Native Americans is widening and continued use of Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames does not empower Native American students towards academic achievement and success; and

WHEREAS the continued use of Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames, by educational institutions, has a negative impact on the self-esteem of Native American children; and

WHEREAS the continued use of Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames establishes an unwelcome, divisive, and often times hostile learning environment for Native American students and affirms negative images and stereotypes that are promoted in mainstream society; and

WHEREAS the continued use of Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames is considered an offensive and intolerable practice by most in Native American Nations; and

WHEREAS the continued use of Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames teaches non- Native American children and communities that it is acceptable to engage in culturally insensitive behavior and perpetuates inaccurate misconceptions about Native American people, culture, history, sovereignty, government, customs, and traditions; and

WHEREAS the continued use of Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames undermines the ability of Native American tribal nations to portray respectful and accurate images of their history, culture, government, sovereignty, customs, and traditions; and

WHEREAS the board of directors' policy requires the use of mascots and symbols to build school spirit and to promote a sense of school community; and

WHEREAS the board of directors consulted with local tribal council members and historians and determined now is the time to retire all Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nick names throughout the district.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that the Board of Directors of Vancouver School District, for good cause, directs the superintendent to retire all Native American mascots, symbols, images, logos, and nicknames at Columbia River High School and Minnehaha Elementary School.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the district shall retire all mascots, namesakes, official symbols, team names, newspaper titles, yearbook titles, or other official group or publications bearing the name of any ethnic, racial, tribal, or religious group. The board prohibits the use of any race or ethnic group, the stereotype of any existing race or ethnic group, and the personification of any existing race or ethnic group as a mascot, nickname, or symbol for a school team, or school activity.

Adopted this _____ day of September, 2020.

ATTEST:

VANCOUVER SCHOOL DISTRICT NO. 37
CLARK COUNTY, WASHINGTON

_____
Secretary, Board of Directors

_____
President, Board of Directors

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Vice President, Board of Directors

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Director, Board of Directors

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Director, Board of Directors

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Director, Board of Directors

Book	vps policies
Section	6000- Management Support
Title	Procedure - Naming Schools, Facilities and Mascots
Code	6970P
Status	Active
Adopted	August 1, 2018
Last Revised	August 27, 2020
Prior Revised Dates	5/14/19

Procedure – Naming Schools, Facilities and Mascots

I. Naming of School or Facility

The naming of a school and/or district facilities will take place in the following manner:

A. The superintendent will select a committee whose purpose it will be to submit to the superintendent a list of not less than three, nor more than five, names for the new school. The list will briefly state, along with each name, why the committee nominated each name. The committee may solicit nominations from students and the community;

B. The committee will, whenever possible, follow these guidelines:

1. Each nominee shall represent a name in which the community may embrace with lasting pride and significance of educational purpose;
2. The names submitted will not conflict with the names of other schools in the district or surrounding districts; and
3. The use of names of living persons may be considered if the circumstances warrant.

C. The superintendent will review and forward no more than three names to the board for approval. If the committee nominations fail to comply with district policy, the superintendent will direct the committee to reconvene and submit additional recommendations.

D. The board will select the name of the new facility from the list. In recognition of the efforts of those involved in the project, a plaque containing the following information may be attached to a new building:

1. School and/or facilities name;
2. Board-approved construction date;

3. Completion or dedication date;

4. Name of board members as of the board-approved construction date in the following order:

   a. Chair/President;

   b. Vice Chair/President; and

   c. Members (alphabetically)

5. Superintendent as of board-approved construction date; and

6. Architect and contractor names.

E. Formal dedication of the facility will take place on a date and time specified by the board.

II. Changing the Name of a Facility or Portion of a Facility

A. The board may change the name of a facility, or portion thereof, for good cause. Any proposed name change shall follow the procedures outlined in this section.

B. The person(s) proposing the name change should present a proposal to the superintendent.

C. If the superintendent decides that a name change should be considered, the superintendent shall select a committee whose purpose it shall be to solicit feedback from the community, students, and faculty regarding the proposed name change. The committee should prepare a written report summarizing support and opposition to the name change proposal and approve a list of proposed new names. The list shall briefly state, along with each name, why the committee nominated each name. All proposed names shall comply with the naming guidelines of Policy 6970, Naming Schools and Facilities. The report and list should be submitted to the superintendent.

D. If the superintendent determines that a name change should be granted, the proposal, including the report and nominated names, will be recommended to the board.

E. The board may accept or reject the name change proposal.

III. Naming a New Mascot

Selection of a school mascot for a new school shall occur in the following manner:

A. The superintendent or designee shall appoint a committee to make a recommendation of a mascot and symbol;

B. The committee should represent staff, community members, administrators and students who will attend the new school;

C. The committee will survey, poll or solicit nominations for the school mascot and symbol. Additionally, the committee will provide an opportunity for input, nominations or expressions of preference by various segments of the greater school community;

D. The committee will make a final recommendation of no less than three (3), and no more than five (5), mascot names to the superintendent for approval by the board of directors;

E. The board will approve or disapprove the names nominated by the committee: and

F. After approval by the board, students will select, by majority vote, one mascot name and symbol.

IV. Renaming a Mascot

Renaming an existing school mascot shall occur in the following manner:

A. The board may change the name of a mascot or symbol, or portion thereof, for good cause or the Board may direct interested parties to use the process in Section IV (B) through IV (I).

B. Initial consideration for changing a mascot will be based on discussions, managed by school administrators, with students and staff. The school level process shall proceed as follows:

1. The school principal, working with students and staff, shall schedule a school-wide vote on whether to rename the mascot and symbol.

2. If a majority of the student body votes against renaming the school mascot, the mascot and symbol shall remain the same.

3. If the student body votes in favor of changing the mascot, a district administrator or designee, in consultation with school administrators, will begin a community stakeholder engagement process, as described in Section C.

C. The community stakeholder engagement process shall proceed as follows:

1. The district administrator or designee shall establish a process for soliciting input and preferences regarding renaming the mascot from community stakeholders, including community representatives and alumni.

2. Community stakeholders who participate in the community engagement process will vote on whether or not to initiate a mascot and symbol renaming process.

3. The district administrator will collate the input and the votes from the community engagement process.

D. If a majority of both the students and the community stakeholders vote in favor of changing the mascot and/or symbol the school principal will initiate the renaming process as provided in Section IV.G.

E. If either the school student body or the stakeholders vote not to rename the mascot or symbol, the mascot and symbol will remain the same.

F. The mascot or symbol renaming process shall only be initiated once every five (5) school years.

G. If the board changes the name of a mascot and/or symbol; or a majority of the student body and a majority of the greater school community stakeholders vote to rename the mascot and symbol, the school administration will convene a committee to make recommendations for a new mascot and symbol to the board of directors.

1. The principal shall appoint a committee of students, staff, parents, alumni, community members, and administrators to help in selecting a new mascot and symbol;

2. The committee, at the direction of the principal, will conduct a nomination process and make recommendations for a new mascot and symbol;

3. The committee is responsible for surveying, polling or soliciting nominations for a school mascot and symbol. Students and school staff members may nominate a mascot and symbol.

Additionally, there will be an opportunity for input or nominations or expressions of preference by the various segments of the greater school community. Nominations and preferences from all the input shall be collated jointly;

4. The committee will make a final recommendation of no less than three (3), and no more than five (5) mascot names and symbols to the principal. The recommended mascot names must meet the criteria established in board policy;

5. The principal will submit the recommended mascot names to the superintendent for presentation to the board for approval;

6. The Board will approve the names or recommend further submissions by the committee.

H. The mascot or symbol renaming process shall only be initiated once every five (5) school years.

I. If a majority of the student body and a majority of the greater school community stakeholders vote to rename the mascot and symbol, the school administration will convene a committee to make recommendations for a new mascot and symbol to the board of directors.

APPROVED:

Steven T. Webb

Dr. Steven Webb, Superintendent
Vancouver Public Schools

08/27/20
Date

Suggestions for Columbia River High School mascot now being accepted

The community is invited to submit suggestions for a new mascot for Columbia River High School. The school's Chieftain mascot was officially retired on Sept. 8 by the Vancouver Public Schools' Board of Directors. The action to retire the Chieftain mascot was recommended by former students, community members, the Washington State Board of Education, the American Psychological Association and local tribal leaders who support the removal of Native American mascots.

Community members, parents and staff members can submit suggestions using this survey. Current Columbia River students will receive a separate link for suggestions. Both student and community surveys will be open until October 31.

Suggestions must follow VPS board policy and procedures for mascots.

Suggestions should:

- Reflect the geographic or historical features of Hazel Dell, Vancouver, Washington state or the Pacific Northwest
- Avoid names that would cause confusion with other local school mascots, logos or images
- Celebrate the rich traditions and history at Columbia River High School among the students, alumni and community members

A mascot transition team made up of Columbia River High School students, alumni and staff (current and past) will review suggestions for the new mascot and oversee the transition process of changing the mascot.

Timeline:

- Oct. 31, 2020 – Deadline for submissions
- Dec. 17, 2020 – Transition team reviews suggestions and chooses three to five finalists to put forward to the superintendent
- Jan. 14, 2021 – The superintendent brings the finalists to the board of directors for final approval
- Feb. 26, 2021 – Columbia River High School students selects new mascot by a majority vote
- March 2021 – Transition team solicits and selects graphic artwork for mascot
- March 2021 – Event to honor Columbia River history and milestones
- April 2021 – Transition team presents mascot to the community

October 6th, 2020 | **Categories:** Secondary schools (6-12), VPS press releases | **Tags:** Columbia River High School

Community Member Survey

Sasquatch = 19
with a description = 18
with an image = 9

Rapids = 28
with a description = 27
with an image = 2

Royals = 7
with a description =7
with an image = 0

River (aka: no mascot) = 34

Student Survey

Sasquatch = 6
with a description = 5
with an image = 0

Yeti = 1
with a description = 1
with an image = 1

Rapids = 24
with a description = 22
with an image = 1

Royals = 13
with a description =10
with an image = 1

River (aka: no mascot) = 10